Perseverant Digital
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A FIELD GUIDE FROM PERSEVERANT DIGITAL · FOR RECRUITING AND STAFFING

The Seminar Seat-to-Client Playbook

Plan an educational seminar or webinar that fills seats, gets registrants to actually show up, and turns the people in the room into booked consultations.

THE SHORT ANSWER · 60 WORDS

REVIEWED OCTOBER 15, 2026

Educational seminars and webinars still work when the decision is large and the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone. Pick a topic phrased as the question your audience already has, promote two to three weeks out, send reminders by email and consented text, teach without pressure, and call every attendee within 72 hours to book the next conversation.

Is an event right for your business?

An event is worth the effort when the decision is large, the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone, and you have someone who can teach in plain language. People are not only searching to find you; they are searching to understand you. A good event lets them do that in an hour.

- [ ] Buyers hesitate for weeks or months because the decision costs or matters a lot.
- [ ] You have a presenter who explains clearly and does not oversell.
- [ ] You can name one next step, such as a consultation, a home assessment or a tour.
- [ ] Someone can call every attendee within a day or two.

All four checked means an event is worth a trial. Otherwise, fix the gaps first.

What this looks like for recruiting and staffing firms

Employer-side webinars fit busy plant, operations and HR managers who will not drive across town but will join 40 minutes from their desk. The topic is their problem, not your service.

There is fresh material. Staffing Industry Analysts forecast on September 6, 2026 that the US staffing market will grow 2.4% in 2026 to $183.1 billion. A market-outlook webinar built on current data gives a hiring manager a reason to attend and to forward it to a peer.

Many registrants will watch the replay instead. Treat replay viewers as warm and count them separately. Make the next step a 30-minute hiring plan review, offered by a person, not just an automated email.

What topic will actually fill seats?

Phrase the topic as the question your audience already asks, not as your service name. A title that names their worry fills seats. Rewrite these in the words your clients use on the phone.

Employer audience	Topic phrased as the audience's question
Operations and plant managers	What the hiring market for skilled trades looks like next year, and how to plan for it
Hiring managers	How to fill a key role when the obvious candidates are taken
HR and finance leaders	What contract-to-hire really costs compared with a direct hire
HR leaders	Why good candidates drop out of your hiring process, and how to fix it

Question my clients ask most	Who asks it	Could I teach it in 45 minutes? (Y/N)

Should it be in person, a webinar or both?

Go in person when trust is the main barrier and the audience is local. Go webinar when the audience is spread out or busy. Choose hybrid only if you

can staff two rooms at once.

Factor	In person	Webinar	Hybrid
Builds trust	Fastest	Moderate	Strong in the room only
Cost per attendee	Higher	Lower	Highest to run well
Biggest risk	Empty seats you paid for	Low live attendance	Neither audience gets full attention

Judge any format by cost per booked consultation, not cost per registration.

What does the 21-day timeline look like?

Promote two to three weeks out, as ON24, an enterprise webinar platform, advised on November 26, 2025. ON24 also advises reminders one week, one day and 15 minutes before; we add a confirmation and a morning-of message for local events.

Day	Task	Done
−28	Pick topic, date, venue or platform, and presenter	[ ]
−24	Build the registration page (checklist below) and confirmation email with a calendar link	[ ]
−21	Test reminders end to end; launch ads, email your list, send partners a blurb to forward	[ ]
−14	Second email; review cost per registration and cut what is not working	[ ]
−7	One-week reminder (email, text optional) with one thing they will learn	[ ]
−3	Rehearse; confirm room, tech and staff	[ ]
−1	One-day reminder (email and text) with time, place or link, parking or tech note	[ ]
0	Morning-of and 15-minute texts with the address or link; run the event	[ ]
+1 to +3	72-hour follow-up (below)	[ ]

Registration page checklist:

- [ ] Headline that repeats the topic question, with date, time and place above the form
- [ ] Three bullets on what attendees will learn, and a short factual presenter bio
- [ ] Form: name, email, phone, and an unchecked text-consent box that says they can reply STOP
- [ ] A plain line that the event is educational and nobody will be pressured

How many registrations do you actually need?

Work backward from the seats you want filled.

Seats wanted ÷ show rate = registrations needed Registrations needed ÷ page conversion rate = clicks needed Clicks needed × cost per click = estimated ad budget

Example numbers, not benchmarks. For 30 people in the room at a 50% show rate, you need 60 registrations. At 15% page conversion, that is 400 clicks. At $2.50 per click, about $1,000 in ads.

For context, ON24 reported a 60% average registrant-to-attendee rate in its 2025 data (June 19, 2026). That is a vendor figure drawn mostly from B2B enterprise webinars, not a target.

Line	Your number
Seats wanted	
Expected show rate	
Registrations needed	
Page conversion rate	
Clicks needed	
Cost per click	
Estimated ad budget	
Consultations booked	
Ad budget ÷ consultations booked	

Run the last line after every event. It tells you whether to keep going.

What should happen during and after the event?

Teach first and name one next step. Answer the title question in the first ten minutes, leave 15 minutes for questions, and explain exactly what happens in the consultation, assessment or tour. End with a feedback card or poll: “Would you like someone to call you?” yes or no.

Then move fast. In Harvard Business Review research on online leads (March 2011), firms that contacted leads within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify them as firms that waited longer. Attendees are warmer than web leads, but the clock still applies.

When	Attendees	Registered no-shows
Same day	Thank-you email with a summary and booking link	Replay or next date
Day 1	Call everyone who said yes on the card	Text (with consent) offering the replay
Day 2	Call remaining attendees once	Second email with one key point
Day 3	Email anyone not reached with a booking link	Invite to the next event

Track each attendee in one list: attended, wants a call, called, booked, became a client.

What compliance items apply?

Check these before launch. This is general information, not legal advice.

- **Meta employment category.** Job ads fall under it; ads selling services to employers generally do not, but check each campaign.
- **No outcome promises.** Do not promise time-to-fill or placement results.
- **Texting.** The TCPA still requires prior express written consent for autodialed marketing texts. Since April 11, 2025, people can revoke by any reasonable means, such as replying STOP, and opt-outs must be honored within 10 business days (Kelley Drye; Burr & Forman).

- **Email.** CAN-SPAM covers B2B email too: accurate headers, a postal address and opt-outs honored within 10 business days (FTC). Bulk Gmail senders also need SPF, DKIM and DMARC (Google, February 1, 2024).

Where do most owners get stuck?

> **Filling seats at a sane cost.** The first event shows your real cost per registration. Lowering it takes testing topics, audiences and creative across several events before the money runs out.

> **Reminder automation across email and text.** A sequence that pulls from your form, respects text consent, honors STOP and stops for cancellations takes systems work most teams do not have time for.

> **Turning registrants into live conversations.** Busy managers register, skip the live session and watch the replay later, if at all. Tracking replay views and following up with the right message takes systems most firms only half use.

If any of these sound familiar, a 25-minute exploration call can help you sort out the next step. Use the short form at the end of this guide.

Sources

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- Federal Trade Commission, “CAN-SPAM Act: A Compliance Guide for Business,” accessed October 15, 2026. link
- Google, “Email Sender Guidelines,” February 1, 2024. link

- Meta, “Special Ad Category,” Marketing API documentation, accessed October 15, 2026. link
- Staffing Industry Analysts, “US Staffing Industry Forecast: September 2026 Update,” September 6, 2026. link

Want a second set of eyes on what you found?

Book a free 25-minute exploration call. We will look at your answers with you, name the first fixes in order, and tell you honestly if we are not the right fit.

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